

Elliot Moxcey

CHILD

A boy who has been playing in the mud. Face, knees and hands.

EURYDICE by Sarah Ruhl

Directed by Elia Monte-Brown

Costume Design: Kaylee Renaud

Costume Associate: Z Weschler

Costume Assistant: Ollie Reece

HEADSHOT

TIME
30 minutes

HELP NEEDED
None. You can do all of this yourself.

BEFORE YOU START
Your regular stage makeup should already be finished and powdered. This goes on top of it.

WHERE IT GOES

- Your face in smudges. Heaviest on your cheeks and jaw, along your hairline and around your nose. Lighter across your forehead.
- Not on your eyelids and not on the skin right around your eyes.
- Both knees and a little way down your shins.
- Your fingers and the backs of your hands, heaviest at the fingertips and knuckles, and under your nails.
- Nowhere else.

SUPPLIES

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| ☐ Grey brown water activated paint | ☐ Red rubber stipple sponge |
| ☐ Warm reddish brown water activated paint | ☐ Thin liner brush for the grass streaks |
| ☐ Dark brown or black water activated paint | ☐ Translucent powder and a puff |
| ☐ Olive green water activated paint for the grass | ☐ Setting spray |
| ☐ Two natural sea sponges, torn not cut | ☐ Full length mirror, water cup, paper towels |

STEPS

- 1 Powder your base and set up** 3 min
Dust translucent powder over your face, knees and hands so the paint has something to grab. Roll your trousers up or change first. You do not want to be pulling fabric over wet knees.
- 2 Face: lay the dirt** 7 min
Wet a sea sponge, pick up grey brown, and press it on in uneven smudges. Press, do not drag. Heaviest on your cheeks and jaw, along your hairline and around your nose, lighter across your forehead. Then warm brown on the second sponge pressed into the middle of the heaviest patches. Leave clean skin between the smudges. Make one cheek dirtier than the other. Dirt is never symmetrical and the moment it is, it reads as makeup.
- 3 Face: add the fine speckle** 4 min
Dip the red sponge in dark brown, blot most of it off on a paper towel, then press it over the smudges. Fine and scattered, heaviest where the dirt is already heaviest. This is the difference between dirt and a shadow.
- 4 Face: three or four grass streaks** 3 min
Load the liner with olive green and drag three or four short streaks, not more. Along your jaw, one at a temple, one on a cheek. Drag these, do not press. They are the only dragged marks on your face and they are the detail that sells the rest.
- 5 Knees** 5 min
Do these standing up so the dirt falls where it would if you had actually knelt down. Grey brown first, heaviest right on the kneecap, then fading down your shin. Warm brown into the middle, then speckle. Make the two knees different. Nobody kneels evenly.
- 6 Fingers and hands** 5 min
Backs of your hands and your fingers. Grey brown first, then warm brown, then speckle, same order as your knees. Heaviest at the fingertips and over the knuckles, and get a little under your nails. Work the grey brown into the creases of your knuckles with the corner of a sea sponge. That is where real dirt sits. Leave your palms clean.
- 7 Seal it** 3 min
Powder everything. Spray with setting spray from arm's length with your eyes closed. Let your hands and knees dry all the way before you touch your costume.

TIPS

- Press the sponge in smudges. Do not paint shapes. Anything with an outline reads as makeup.
- One cheek dirtier than the other. Symmetrical dirt is the giveaway.
- Leave clean skin showing between the smudges. Solid coverage reads as a mask.
- Three or four grass streaks only. They are the detail, not the layer.
- Fingertips, knuckles and under the nails. That is where a boy who has been digging is dirtiest.
- Palms stay clean. Nobody gets dirty on the inside of their hands.
- Do your knees standing up, so it lands where kneeling would put it.
- Keep it off your eyelids and out of your eyes.
- This will transfer. Test your hands and knees against your costume before dress.
- Off with soap and warm water, then micellar on the sealed areas.

REFERENCE



The look. Smudged, uneven, skin showing through.



Close up. Fine speckle over the smudge, plus a grass streak.